



Introduction to Microsoft Word

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What is Microsoft Word

Microsoft Word is capable of complex graphic design. You can include images, tables, graphs and shapes in your documents. It is a *word processing* program, a tool for writing, editing, designing, and printing written documents. You can use Microsoft Word for writing, editing and designing:

- Resumes
- Posters
- Letters
- Text Documents
- Flyers
- Detect grammatical errors in text
- Brochures
- Business Cards
- Invoices
- Etc.

Key Vocabulary

Character: is a number, letter, punctuation mark, space, or any other input from the keyboard. For example:

- The word “HAPPY” has five characters.
- The sentence “YOU ARE COOL” has 12 characters including the spaces.
- A 3 p m !) h F / \$: j are all examples of individual characters.

Font: is a type face of instructions for what shape characters should be. Some examples of fonts include:

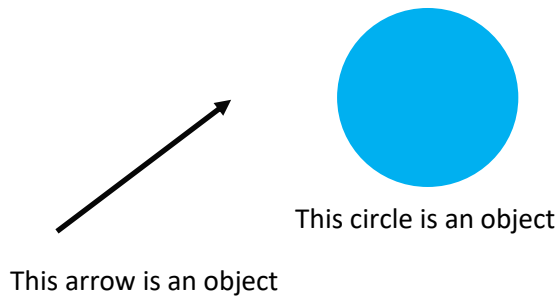
abcABC123 *abcABC123* abcABC123 *abcABC123*

Paragraph: is a chunk of text that ends with a line break, it usually comprises of more than one sentence. These two sentences together form a paragraph. The next sentence will be the start of a new paragraph.

Section: is part of the document that controls larger formatting. A section can be as long or as short as needed. Every document has at least one section, if you need more than one section, you need to add them.

Object: is something that is not part of the main flow of text but is something you add onto the page along with the main text. Examples of objects include a line, a shape, a picture and a text box.

An **object** is something that is not part of the main flow of text but that you want to put on the page along with the main text. It might be a picture, a shape, a line, or a text box – like this one!



This flower image is an object

How Everything Fits Together

Microsoft Word is designed around the model of putting a stream of text on a page or multiple pages.

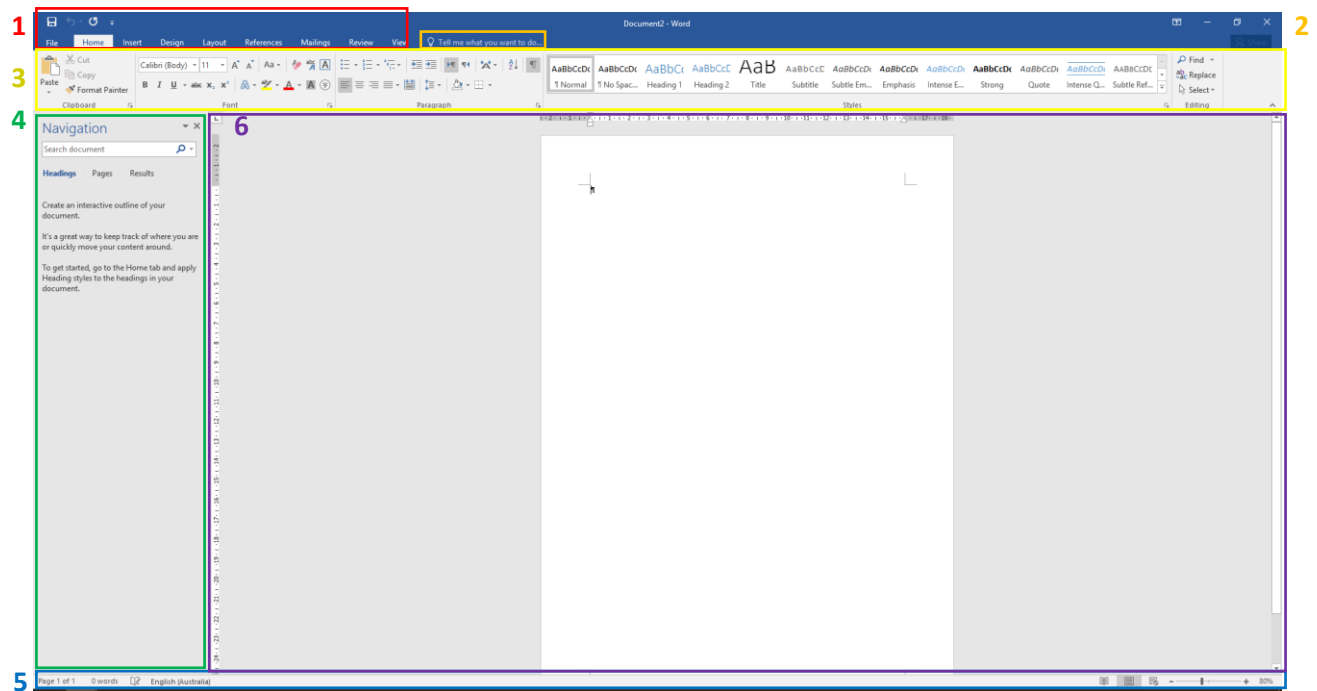
Formatting can be applied to each individual character, selected paragraphs, and selected pages and in a section of the document. Formatting can also be applied within separate section on one page. For example, there could be two different tables on one page of the document with each table being formatted differently to have different characteristics. Some types of page formatting include:

- Number of columns on the page
- Paper and size orientation (landscape or horizontal)
- Margins
- Headers & Footers
- Background colour/images and watermarks

You can add extra objects on a page like pictures, shapes and text boxes. You can make the text flow around them or make them sit behind or in front of text on the page. The basic model is that there is a layer of text and everything else is positioned relative to the text.

The Window

The Microsoft Word window is made up of various parts as shown:



1. The menu bar

changes what's in the ribbon (see #3 below), and allows you to save and undo.

2. The contextual hint box

type what you want to do in this box and the computer will guess at hints and shortcuts for how to do it.

3. The ribbon

buttons you can click to do things. Choosing a different menu changes the buttons.

4. Sidebars

these are optional. They don't always appear, and you may see different sidebars at different times.

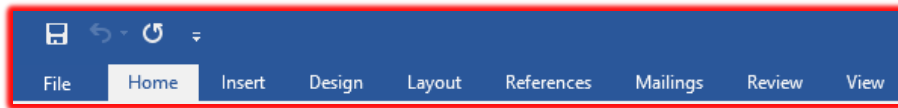
5. The status bar

this gives you summary information: page count, word count, etc. The controls at bottom right change how the computer shows you the document.

The working window

this shows you your document. By default it previews the actual final printed page, but you can change how it displays your work using the controls in the status bar

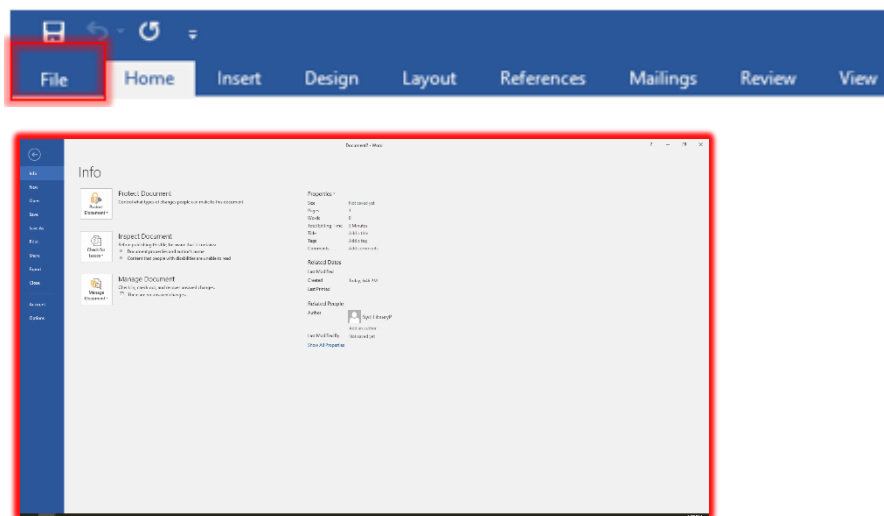
The Menu Bar



The menu bar changes which controls are quickly accessible and available for you to use in the ribbon, or in the case of the 'File' menu, in the whole Microsoft Word window.

Depending on what you currently have selected in the working window, some additional menu options will appear at the end of the menu bar. For example, if you are working on a table, table tools will appear in the menu bar. If you are working on a picture then additional picture tools will appear in the menu bar. The most common menus that will appear while you are working on your document are the 'Table', 'Picture' and 'Drawing' tools. These menu options only appear when the appropriate object is currently selected for example a table, picture or shape.

File Menu



Opening the 'File' menu changes the whole Word window rather than just the ribbon at the top. (See above image)

The 'File' menu controls the external aspects of word document such as:

- Starting a new file,
- Where the file is saved
- What the file is called (file name),
- What format the file is saved in (Microsoft word, PDF, plain text, etc.)

- Opening and closing existing files
- Printing, etc.

Learning Exercise:

Saving a document

Type your full name (first name and last name) on the screen.

Click on the **File** menu on the top left of the window and choose **Save As**.

Select **This PC**.

Select **Documents** as the save location.

Choose and type a name for the file and click **Save**.

Opening a new document

Click on the **File** menu and choose **New**.

Hover the mouse over **Blank Document**,

Click on **Create**.

Now you have 2 documents open at the same time and can work on them both at the same time.

Closing a document

Click on the **File** menu.

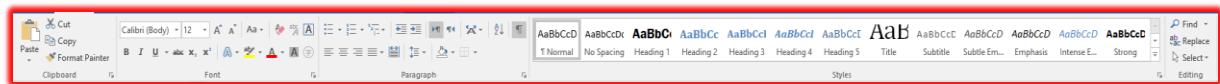
Then click **Close**.

(Alternatively you can also close a document by click on the 'X' on the top right corner)

Open an existing document

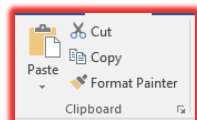
You can either double click on the document you just saved on the desktop to open it or open it inside a Microsoft Word window.

Home Menu



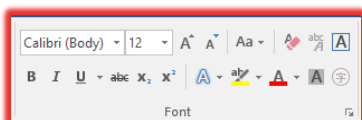
The home menu covers the most common tools used in a Microsoft Word document. Sections of the 'Home' menu that are commonly used include:

Clipboard



The clipboard section includes tools to 'Cut', 'Copy', and 'Paste' objects, characters, words and paragraphs within the documents – or between documents and programs. You can use the 'Format Painter' tool to transfer formatting from section of text to another section. To do this click to put your cursor in the middle of the text which you want to copy the formatting from. Then select the text you want to copy the formatting to.

Font



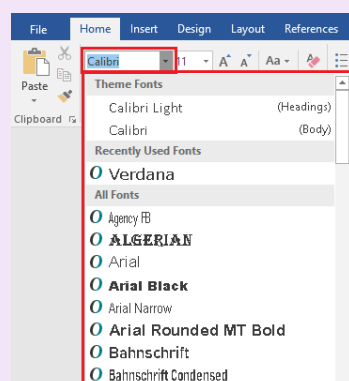
The font controls let you change the look of the text that you type. You can change things such as the font size, colour, and style. Let's practice using some font tools.

Learning Exercise - Font Selection

Type "Today is a good day".

Select the sentence by dragging the mouse over it.

Change the font style by clicking on the font dialogue box and selecting one.



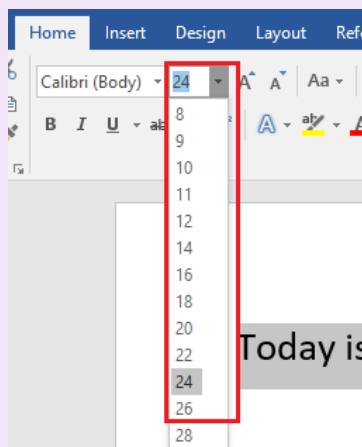
Note that different fonts use more or less space depending on the style. For example fonts which are set at the same sizes may look smaller or larger. Practice selecting a few fonts to see the different styles available and notice the difference in sizes.

Learning Exercise - Font Size

Select the sentence “Today is a good day” by dragging the mouse over it.

Adjust the font size by clicking on the size dialogue box and selecting number ‘24’.

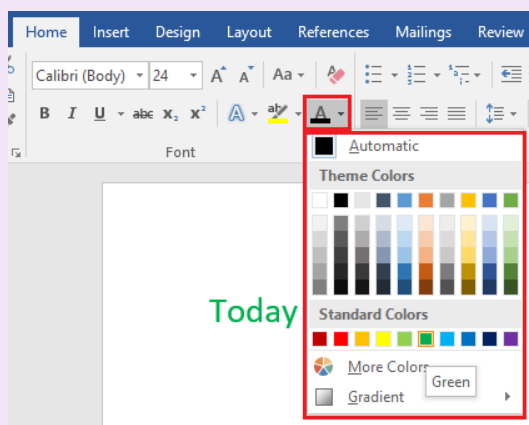
This will make the sentence appear bigger.



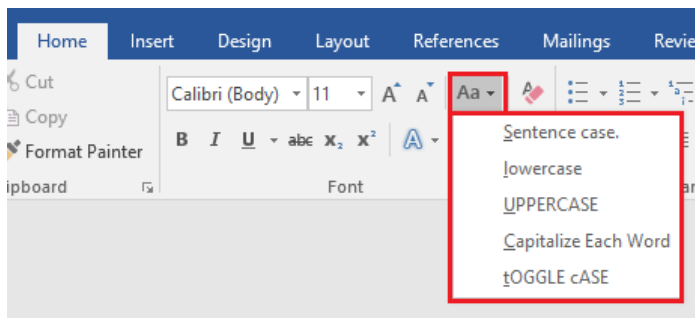
Learning Exercise - Font Colour

Select the sentence “Today is a good day” by dragging the mouse over it.

Change the font colour to make your name appear green by selecting it from the colour dialogue box.



Changing Case: uppercase and lowercase



The 'changing' case button allows you to change the case of text. For example, you can:

- CHANGE IT TO ALL CAPITALS,
- change text to all lower case,
- Capitalise Each Word,
- Change it to sentence case. (This means only the first letter of a new sentence or paragraph is capital)
- Toggle between cases to swap upper and lower case so that

ThIs SeNtEnCe iS wObBlY becomes **tHIs sEnTeNcE Is wOBBlY**. (Notice how all the upper case letters turn into lower case and the lower case letters turn into uppercase.)

Learning Exercise – Changing Case

Select the Sentence "Today is a good day"

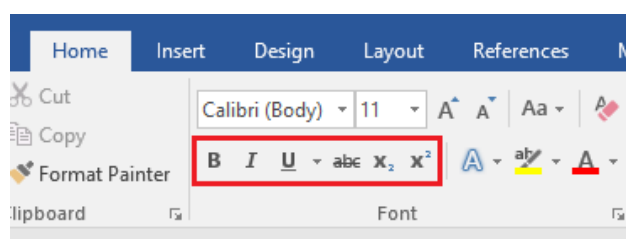
Use the 'Change Case' button to:

- Make it all lower case
- Make it all UPPERCASE
- Capitalise Each Word

****Note****

You can also change cases manually one letter at a time by using the CAPSLOCK key or using the SHIFT key in between typing each letter.

Text Formatting



Text formatting tools are those highlighted above. These functions are:

- **B = Bold** – a heavier, darker version of the characters with thicker lines, used for headings and emphasis.
- *I = Italic* – slanted letters, used for foreign words and emphasis, especially urgency.
- U = Underline – puts a line under the characters. The drop-down arrow lets you choose from a range of underline styles.
- ~~abc~~ = **Strikethrough** – draws a line through the text, suggesting a correction.
- x_2 – called “subscript”, this lowers and shrinks the characters and is most often used for chemical formulas. (For example CO_2 and 23^{rd})
- x^2 – called “superscript”, this raises and shrinks the characters and is most often used for footnotes and endnotes (though if you use the proper tool it will automatically format the footnote marks).

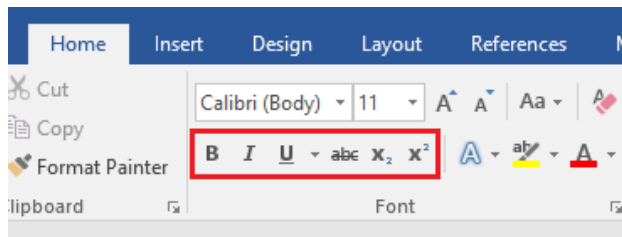
Learning Exercise – Text Formatting

Select the Sentence “Today is a good day”

Use the ‘Text Formatting’ buttons to:

- Make it all **bold**
- Make it all *italic*
- Underline the sentence
- Put a ~~strike~~ through the sentence

Colour Formatting



The above buttons allow you to add colour to your text in various ways.



The first button brings up a menu of text design options for you to choose from such as shadow, reflection and glow features.

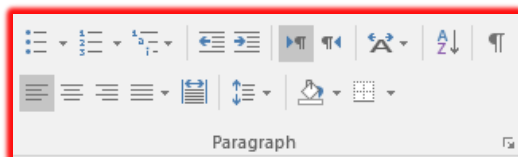


The second button is the highlighting function. Clicking this changes the cursor of your mouse to a highlighter pen. You can then highlight a word/sentence in your document.



The third button enables you to change the colour of your font you type.

Paragraph



The paragraph section controls the formatting of entire paragraphs which we will cover on the next page.

Bullets and Numbering



These buttons enable you to order paragraphs into different list designs such as bullets, numbered lists and multi-level lists. Clicking the button lets you use the default settings for each type of list. You can click the drop down arrow beside each icon to change to see different options

Learning Exercise – Bullets and Numbering

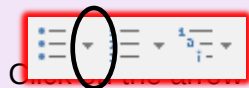
Imagine you are going to the market today. Type a shopping list of what you need to buy.

1. Type 5 items. One item per line.

2. Highlight your shopping list.



3. Click on the 'bullets' button to add dot points in front of each item.



4. Click on the dropdown arrow next to the bullet button to change the bullet style.

5. Click on the 'numbered list' button to turn your list into a numbered list.



Increase / Decrease Left Indent



These buttons enable you to move the left edge of your text in toward the margin or push it out away from the margin

Learning Exercise – Paragraph indents

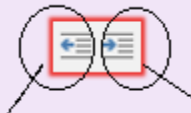
1. Practice typing some lines. Type the following 3 sentences:

Today is a good day. We are learning how to type and use basic functions in Microsoft Word.

The weather is funny in Melbourne. Sometimes it is sunny in winter and sometimes it is raining in summer.

There are many things you can do outdoors to keep healthy. These include going for walks and going for runs at the park.

2. Experiment with using the left indent buttons but clicking on one of the sentences you just typed and keep the cursor at the front of the sentence. Click on the indent buttons to see the paragraphs.



Pulls the left edge
back toward the
margin

Pushes the left edge
out away from the
margin

Sort Paragraphs



This button allows you to sort paragraphs alphabetically and can be especially useful if they are in list form. For example, you can sort shopping lists, guest lists and product lists.

Learning Exercise – Sorting Paragraphs

1. Make a shopping list of 5 items. One item per line. For example

Orange juice for dad.

Wholemeal bread for little brother.

Rock sugar for dessert tonight.

Plain flour to make cookies.

Tomatoes for salad.

2. Highlight the entire list, then click on the 'sort paragraphs' button.



3. Results: The shopping list should now be rearranged into alphabetical order and look like this:

*Note how the first letter in each sentence is now alphabetised.

Orange juice for dad.

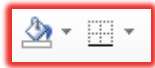
Plain flour to make cookies.

Rock sugar for dessert tonight.

Tomatoes for salad.

Wholemeal bread for little brother.

Background Colours and Borders

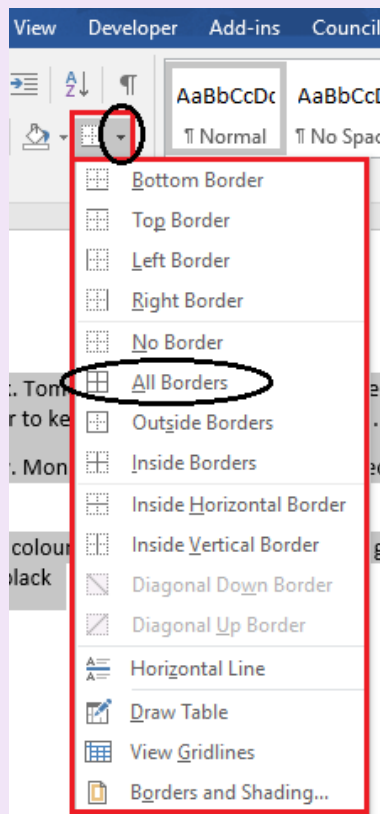


These buttons allow you to draw borders around paragraphs and lets you set background colours within these borders. Let's practice applying borders and backgrounds.

Learning Exercise – Adding borders and colours

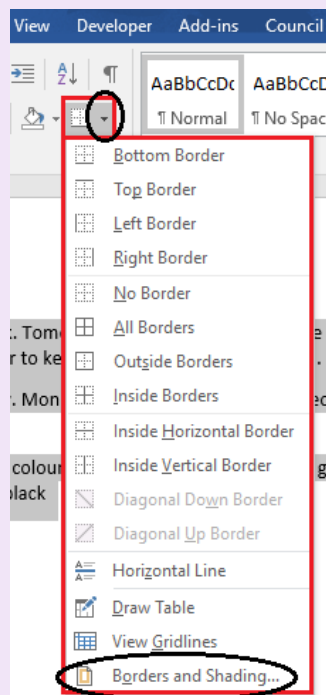
We will use the same shopping list text that was typed in the previous learning exercise.

1. Highlight the entire text
2. Click on the arrow adjacent to the 'border' button. Then select the 'Outside Borders' option.

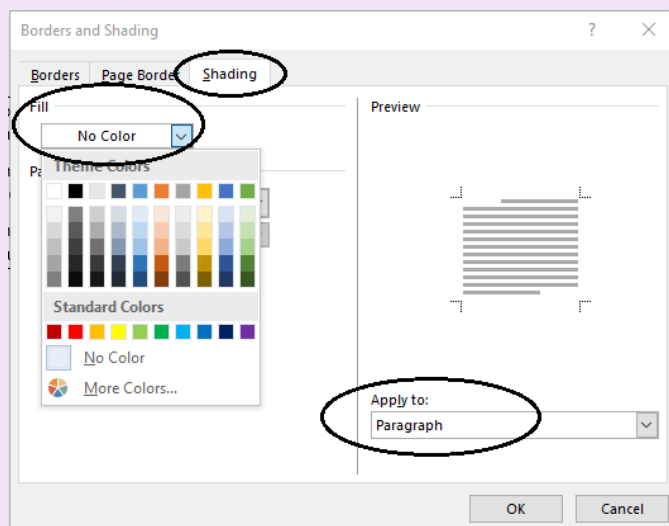


You should see that a thin black border is now placed around the text that was highlighted.

3. Again, click on the arrow adjacent to the 'border' button. Then select the 'Borders and Shading'.

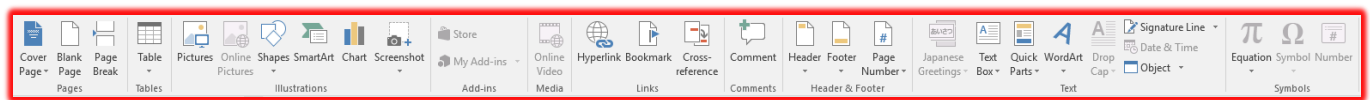


4. In the 'Borders and Shading' window,
- Click on the "Shading" tab.
 - Pick a colour to "Fill" the background in.
 - Select "Apply to: Paragraph"



*You will now see the area inside the black border has a background in the colour you chose.

Insert Menu



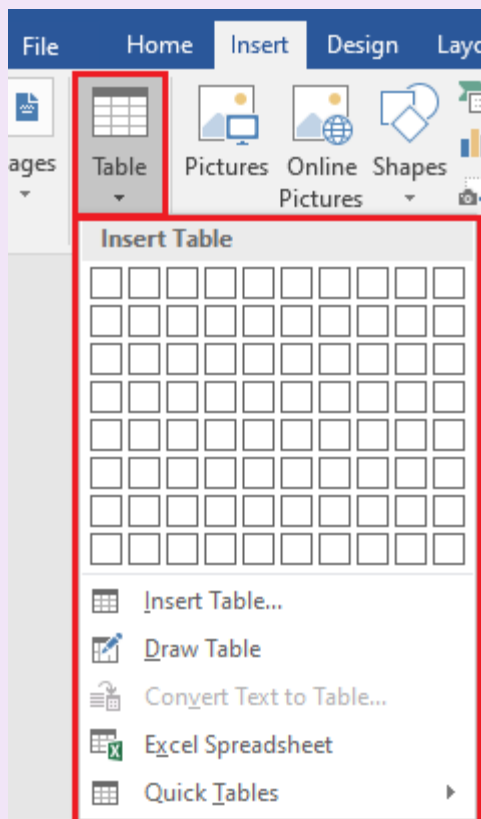
The insert menu allows you to insert various kinds of objects into your text. Common objects that are regularly inserted into a document include page numbers, word art headings, pictures, shapes and tables. We will learn how to insert these common objects.

Inserting Tables

Tables are useful objects for when you need to organise text into categories for easy viewing. The 'insert table' menu gives you options to choose the number of rows and columns that are required. You can also modify tables to have different designs, lengths, widths and borders.

Learning Exercise – Inserting Tables

1. From the insert menu, click on the 'Table' button. Move the mouse cursor within the boxes to select your desired rows and columns.



2. Play around with the table; make it bigger, smaller, change the colours and borders etc.

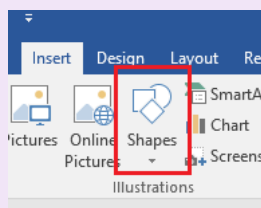
Inserting Shapes

Microsoft Word has a large number of pre-set shapes for you to choose from. After inserting shapes, you can modify their characteristics and design. For example, a shapes border and colour can be changed. You can also make the shape as small or as big as needed.

Learning Exercise – Inserting Shapes

Insert a circle shape into your document.

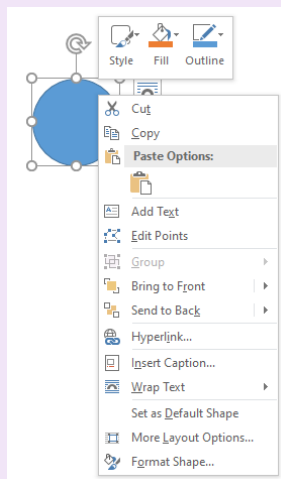
1. Click on the “Shapes” button from the ‘Insert’ menu.



2. Select the circle shape in the options available. The cursor will change to a cross symbol and look like this:



3. Click anywhere in your document to place the circle shape.
4. To change the shape style (colour, border, design), right click on the circle to bring up design options as below.



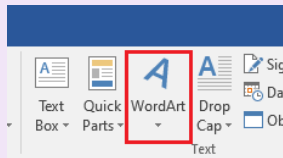
5. Play around with the different design options to change the colour and border style of your shape.

Inserting Word Art

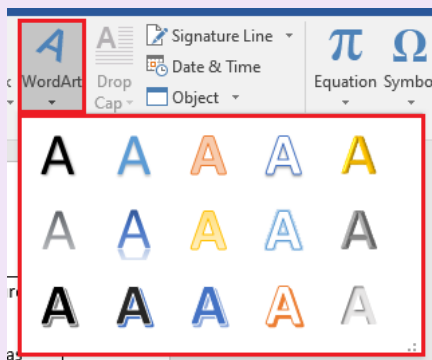
Word Art is a quick and easy way to add headings into your documents. They are pre-designed to be large, eye catching and obvious

Learning Exercise – Insert a Word Art Heading

1. From the insert menu select the “Word Art” button.



2. Choose a Word Art design from the list and click on it.



3. A text box with your chosen word art design will appear in the document. Click on it and type your name inside the text box.



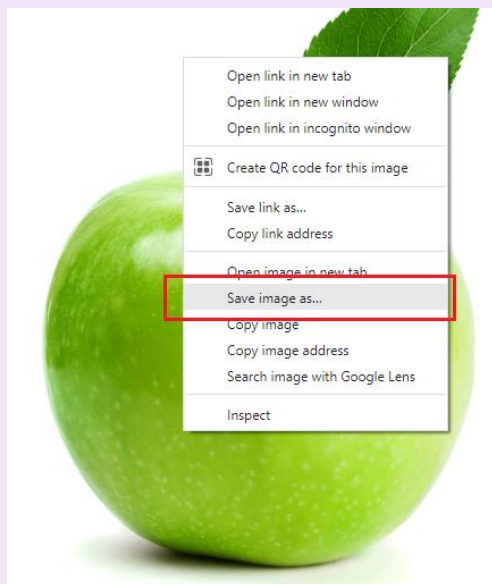
4. Practice dragging the Word Art around the page.
5. Practice adding different Word Arts into the document.

Inserting Pictures

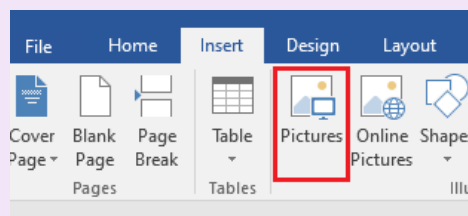
There are various ways you can insert a picture into Microsoft Word. These includes copying and pasting an image from an internet browser. In this section we will practice inserting a picture from the computer which has been downloaded from the internet.

Learning Exercise – Inserting Online Pictures

1. Open an internet browser (like Chrome, Firefox, IE) and do an image search for a fruit you like.
2. **Right click** on the image and select “**Save Image As**”. Rename your image and save it to “**Documents**”.



3. Now go back to Microsoft Word. From the insert menu, click on “**Pictures**” as below.



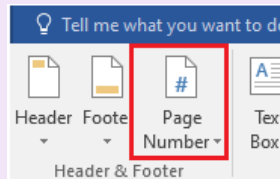
4. Search for and select the image in the “**Documents**” folder and click “**insert**”.

Inserting Page Numbers

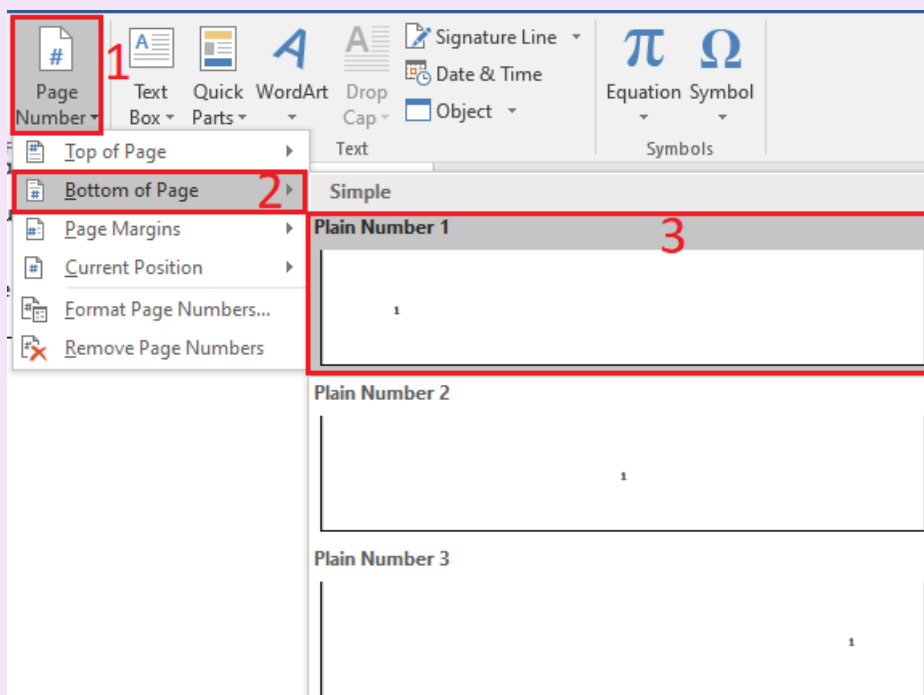
Page numbers can be useful and important for documents with multiple pages. There are various page number designs to choose from, for example, having the page number at the top, bottom, bottom left, bottom right etc.

Learning Exercise – Insert Page Numbers

1. From the insert menu, click on the “Page Number” button.



2. From the drop down list, select “BOTTOM OF PAGE” → “PLAIN NUMBER”



3. Scroll to the bottom of the page. You will see that a page number has been inserted.

Note: As more pages are added to your document, the page numbers will be automatically added to each new page in order. You can also set your page numbers to appear at the top of the page instead of at the bottom.

Let's Practice!

Let's Practice

Now that we've covered the basics of Microsoft Word. Use what you've learnt to create a birthday invitation to invite your family and friends to your birthday party.

Include the following:

- To: (name of person you are inviting)
- Reason for the invitation
- Place of the party (address)
- Time of the party
- Any other special notes or requirements you need from your guests
- Include a picture(s)
- Include a border
- Design your invitation to your liking, play with different fonts / texts / colours / shapes and backgrounds

Have fun!



Program Feedback

Brimbank Libraries
Imagine, Explore, Discover, Connect



Help us make our programs the best possible

Which library do you visit the most? Deer Park Keilor St Albans Sunshine Sydenham

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

What language/s do you speak at home?

What program did you attend today?

What did you think of today's program?



☐ Could be better



☐ Okay



☐ Liked it



☐ Loved it

Why? What did you like? What can we do better?

.....

.....

Did you learn something new from your visit? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Did you make a new connection today? ☐ Yes ☐ No

What else did you do at the library today?

☐ Borrow items ☐ Use WIFI, Computers or Print ☐ Other

☐ Return items ☐ Become a library member

How can we BEST tell you about future programs?

☐ Library Brochure /Posters ☐ Social Media ☐ Library Email Newsletter

☐ Other

☐ Yes, please email me the library newsletter

My email:

Help us make our programs the best possible

Is there anything else you want to tell us about the libraries?

Privacy Statement

Information collected on this form will be handled in accordance with Brimbank City Council's Information Privacy and Health Records Policy available at:

<https://www.brimbank.vic.gov.au/plans-policies-and-strategies/policies/information-privacy-and-health-records-policy>

